

VAIREMONT

THE BETROTHAL DINNER

Iolanthe Vairemont *and* Teodor Wend

The fourteenth evening of Arodus, 4725

SEATING, AS ARRANGED BY THE HOUSE

¹ His Grace Ansel Vairemont

Duke of Vairemont, at the head

² Iolanthe Vairemont

daughter to His Grace

³ Teodor Wend

betrothed

⁴ The Dowager Marchioness

Perpetua Wend

mother to Master Teodor

⁵ Odile Wend

sister to Master Teodor

⁶ Bellamy Vairemont

brother to His Grace

⁷ Lady Marisol Vairemont-Enn

cousin, lately returned

⁸ Sister Aldeth Corvane

to officiate

⁹ Canon Fessimer Oyle

of the same house

¹⁰ Master Girard Pell

solicitor to the House

¹¹ Lady Sabetha Crowe

of Crowe's Ford, neighbour

Eleven at table. Covers laid accordingly.

Havel, for the House

FOR THE EVENING OF THE FOURTEENTH

Remarks at the betrothal of my daughter

fourth attempt. this one, and then I stop.

My daughter has always known her own mind.

She knew it at six, when she informed me that the pony was to be called Admiral and would answer to nothing else, and was proved correct, because the pony would not.

She knew it at nineteen, when she told me what she intended to study. She did not ask me. I have thought about that a great deal since and I have concluded that she was right not to.

Teodor — you are marrying a woman who cannot be argued with. I think you already understand this, which is a good deal more than I understood at your age, and I am glad of it.

I will say only ~~that I know exactly what your mother is that the Dowager Marchioness and I have had our dealings~~ that his mother and I have done business together before now, and that I have learned to read a contract twice in her company, and that I trust this arrangement between our houses will be conducted on better terms than the last one was.

*leave it. she knows what she did.
she was kind at the funeral.*

To Iolanthe and Teodor.

*don't look at Perpetua when you say it
— you always look at her when you say it*

ARTICLES OF PERPETUAL RETAINER

between the House of Vairemont and the Bound Party hereinafter named · Copy held by the Solicitor to the House

ARTICLE III — OF THE OCCASION, AND OF ITS PERFECTION

- 3 (a)** The Bound Party shall attend upon each and every betrothal feast held by or on behalf of the House of Vairemont, and shall ensure that no such betrothal feast is, in any particular howsoever small, less than perfect. The determination of perfection shall rest with the Bound Party alone and shall not be subject to appeal by the House. Where a betrothal feast is found wanting, the Bound Party shall set the occasion again from its commencement, and shall continue so to set it until such time as the betrothal feast is concluded without fault, or until the House of Vairemont is extinguished, whichever shall the sooner occur.
- 3 (b)** The persons of the guests, being party to the occasion, shall at each setting be preserved and restored entire, together with such memory and disposition as they held at its commencement. Furnishings, and attendant persons in the employ or hire of the House, not being party to the occasion, are excepted from this provision, and remain throughout the responsibility of the House.
- 3 (c)** The occasion shall be constituted as the written arrangement of the House declares it, in the number of its covers and in the persons named thereupon, and in no other manner. A departure from that arrangement is a want within the meaning of clause 3 (a).
- 3 (d)** This Article is exhausted upon the conclusion of a betrothal feast without fault, whereupon the Bound Party shall be discharged, and the retainer shall be at an end.
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CORWIN VAIREMONT
Third Duke of that name, for the House

QAZRAHIN, called the Fastidious
the Bound Party, by its own hand and in its own name